
WRITE YOUR WEDDING VOWS

A Guided Workbook for
Personal & Meaningful Vows

Daniel Tesfamariam

Write Your Wedding Vows

A Guided Workbook for Personal & Meaningful Vows

Copyright (c) 2025 Daniel Tesfamariam

All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, distributed,
or transmitted in any form without prior written permission.

Published by Daniel Tesfamariam

First Edition, 2025

This workbook is designed to help couples write
heartfelt, personal wedding vows.

Why Personal Vows Matter

Emotional Impact

Personal vows create an emotional connection that resonates deeply with your partner, your guests, and yourself. They transform a ceremony from a formality into a moment of genuine vulnerability and love.

Memory Creation

Your vows become a treasured memory - words you can return to throughout your marriage. They serve as a reminder of what you promised and why you chose each other.

Authenticity vs. Generic Vows

Generic vows are beautiful, but personal vows tell YOUR story. They reflect your unique relationship, your shared experiences, and the specific promises that matter most to the two of you.

Remember: There is no wrong way to write your vows.

The best vows come from the heart and speak honestly about your love and commitment.

Traditional vs. Personal Vows

Traditional Vows

- Time-honored words
- Religious significance
- Familiar to guests
- Less pressure
- Universally understood
- Symbolic weight
- Officiant-led option

Personal Vows

- Unique to you
- Deeply personal
- Tell your story
- Emotional depth
- Memorable moments
- Creative freedom
- Specific promises

When to Use Each:

Traditional: Religious ceremonies, family expectations, comfort with formality, shorter ceremonies.

Personal: Intimate weddings, creative couples, when you want guests to truly know your relationship.

The Hybrid Approach:

Many couples combine both - using traditional vows for the official exchange and adding personal words before or after.

This honors tradition while still sharing your unique story.

You might also weave personal elements into traditional frameworks, keeping the structure but making it yours.

Brainstorming Prompts

Use these prompts to spark ideas. Write freely - don't edit yet!

When I first knew I loved you...

What I promise to you...

How you changed me...

What marriage means to me...

Brainstorming Prompts (continued)

My favorite thing about us...

Our story in 3 moments...

What I admire most about you...

Our inside jokes & references...

Vow Structure Template

A strong vow has three parts. Use this framework as a guide:

1. THE OPENING - Set the tone

Address your partner and establish context.

Example: "[Name], from the moment we met at that coffee shop, I knew my life was about to change..."

2. THE PROMISES - The heart of your vows

Share specific, meaningful commitments.

Example: "I promise to be your biggest fan, to always save you the last slice of pizza, and to hold your hand through every storm life sends."

3. THE CLOSING - End with impact

Wrap up with a powerful declaration of love.

Example: "Today I choose you, and I will choose you every single day for the rest of our lives."

Tips:

- Keep each section roughly equal in length
- Balance humor with sincerity
- Use specific details over generic statements
- Read aloud as you write to test the flow

Word Bank

Choose words that reflect your tone. Mix and match!

ROMANTIC

cherish, adore, forever
devotion, soulmate, eternal
beloved, treasure, embrace

FUNNY

adventure, shenanigans
partner-in-crime, tolerate
weird, chaos, sidekick

POETIC

illuminate, journey, infinite
intertwine, destiny, bloom
anchor, constellation, dawn

SIMPLE

love, home, partner, best
friend, team, always, true
choose, grow, build, stay

Meaningful Verbs:

promise, vow, pledge, commit, dedicate, honor, support,
uplift, encourage, celebrate, protect, nurture, inspire

Adjectives:

unwavering, steadfast, boundless, genuine, fierce,
tender, patient, joyful, grateful, courageous, whole

Useful Phrases:

"in this life and the next" / "through every season"
"with all that I am" / "as long as I breathe"
"you are my home" / "I choose you, always"

Draft 2 - Refine Your Ideas

Rework your favorite parts from Draft 1. Shape them.

Draft 3 - Find Your Voice

Read aloud. Does it sound like you? Adjust the tone.

Final Version

Your finished vows. Practice reading these aloud.

Tips for Delivery

Managing Nervousness

- Take deep breaths before you begin speaking
- Look at your partner - their face will calm you
- Pause between sentences - silence is powerful
- It's okay to cry - your guests expect emotion
- Remember: everyone is rooting for you

Memorization vs. Cue Cards

- Cue cards are perfectly acceptable and recommended
- Write key phrases on a small card, not full text
- Have your officiant hold a backup copy
- Memorizing creates pressure - allow yourself grace

Practice Tips

- Read aloud daily for at least one week before
- Practice in front of a mirror to see your expressions
- Record yourself and listen back for pacing
- Practice with a trusted friend for feedback

Voice Projection

- Speak slowly - nerves make us rush
- Project to the back row, not just your partner
- Ask about microphone options at your venue
- Vary your tone - don't read in a monotone

Vow Length Guide

The Ideal Length: 60-90 Seconds

Most wedding planners and officiants recommend keeping your vows between 60 and 90 seconds when spoken aloud.

Word Count Guidance:

- 30 seconds = approx. 75 words (too short)
- 60 seconds = approx. 150 words (minimum)
- 90 seconds = approx. 225 words (ideal max)

Why This Length Works:

- Long enough to say something meaningful
- Short enough to hold everyone's attention
- Easier to memorize or deliver confidently
- Both partners' vows stay balanced in length

Timing Yourself:

1. Set a timer on your phone
2. Read at a slow, ceremonial pace (not your normal speed)
3. Add 10-15 seconds for pauses and emotion on the day
4. Aim for both partners to be within 30 seconds of each other

Pro tip: Coordinate with your partner on length -

you don't want a 30-second vow following a 3-minute one!

Sample Vows: Funny & Lighthearted

Style: Humorous with a heartfelt ending

[Name], I love you. And I promise to keep loving you even when you steal all the blankets. Even when you leave your socks everywhere. Even when you insist on watching that terrible show for the fifth time.

I promise to laugh at your jokes - even the bad ones - and to always be your partner in every adventure and misadventure. I promise to let you pick the restaurant at least half the time, and to never go to bed angry - mostly because I know you'll want to talk it out anyway.

But seriously - you are my favorite person on this planet. You make ordinary days extraordinary. I choose you today, tomorrow, and for all my tomorrows.

Why it works:

- Opens with humor that guests relate to
- Uses specific, personal details (customize yours!)
- Shifts to sincerity at the end for emotional impact
- Approx. 150 words = about 60 seconds

Sample Vows: Deeply Emotional

Style: Heartfelt, vulnerable, and intimate

[Name], standing here today, I am overwhelmed by the depth of what I feel for you. You came into my life when I wasn't looking, and you changed everything.

You taught me that love isn't just a feeling - it's a choice you make every morning. It's patience when I'm difficult, grace when I fall short, and joy in the smallest moments we share together.

I vow to be your safe place, your greatest champion, and your constant. I promise to hold your hand through the storms and dance with you in the sunshine. You are my home, my heart, and my forever. I love you beyond words - but I will spend my life trying to show you.

Why it works:

- Opens with genuine vulnerability
- Acknowledges what the partner brings to the relationship
- Makes specific, heartfelt promises
- Closes with a powerful declaration

Sample Vows: Faith-Based

Style: Rooted in faith with personal touches

[Name], I believe God brought us together for a purpose. In you, I see His grace, His love, and His plan for my life made beautifully clear.

Before God and our loved ones, I vow to love you as Scripture calls me to - with patience, kindness, and selflessness. I promise to pray with you, grow with you, and build a home rooted in faith.

I promise to seek God first in our marriage, to forgive as we are forgiven, and to trust in His plan when the path is uncertain. You are my answered prayer, my blessing, and my partner in this beautiful journey of faith. I love you today and for all eternity.

Why it works:

- Acknowledges faith as the foundation
- Incorporates scripture themes naturally
- Balances spiritual commitment with personal promises
- Appropriate for religious ceremonies

Sample Vows: Simple & Direct

Style: Clear, honest, and unpretentious

[Name], I love you. It's that simple and that complicated all at once.

I promise to be honest with you, always. I promise to listen when you need to talk and to hold you when words aren't enough. I promise to build a life with you that we're both proud of.

I will be your partner, your teammate, and your best friend. Today, I give you my whole heart. You are enough, and we are enough. I choose you.

Why it works:

- Every word carries weight - nothing extra
- Feels genuine and unscripted
- Easy to deliver without getting emotional
- Short length (about 45 seconds) - perfect for nervous speakers

Sample Vows: Poetic & Literary

Style: Lyrical, metaphorical, and artistic

[Name], you are the dawn after my longest night, the shore my restless heart finally found. In you, I have discovered what poets have tried to capture for centuries - a love that is both quiet and infinite.

I vow to tend the garden of our love with gentle hands.
I vow to be the lighthouse when the fog rolls in, and the soft place to land when the world is too much.

Our story is not written in grand gestures but in the thousand small moments - morning coffee, tangled feet, quiet evenings. These are the verses of our life.

Today I give you my words, my heart, and every chapter yet to be written. You are my poem, my song, my story.

Why it works:

- Rich imagery creates an emotional experience
- Metaphors make abstract feelings tangible
- Rhythmic language is beautiful spoken aloud
- Ideal for literary-minded couples

Partner's Section: Brainstorm

This section is for your partner to brainstorm their vows.

When I first knew I loved you...

What I promise to you...

My favorite memory of us...

What our future looks like to me...

Partner's Section: Final Version

Your polished, final vows. Practice reading these aloud.

Our Vows Keepsake

Record both of your final vows here as a lasting keepsake.

Partner 1:

Name: _____

Partner 2:

Name: _____

Wedding Date: _____